

TradeLab

Guide – full version & demo

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1. Welcome to TradeLab

TradeLab is a trading journal with risk management BEFORE the trade. The first chapters take you from install to your first planned trade in minutes. After that come the features in detail – with formulas and background –, setting up the local AI, updates & data safety, and finally a chapter on the demo version.

Full version or demo?

- **TradeLab** (full version): starts empty, you create your own accounts and trades. No limit.
- **TradeLab-Demo**: starts with over 1,000 sample trades to explore; max. 10 new trades of your own per month.
- Both are separate apps with separate data – you can also install them side by side.

2. Install & launch

Download the matching file from the TradeLab download page (the link you were given).

2.1 Windows

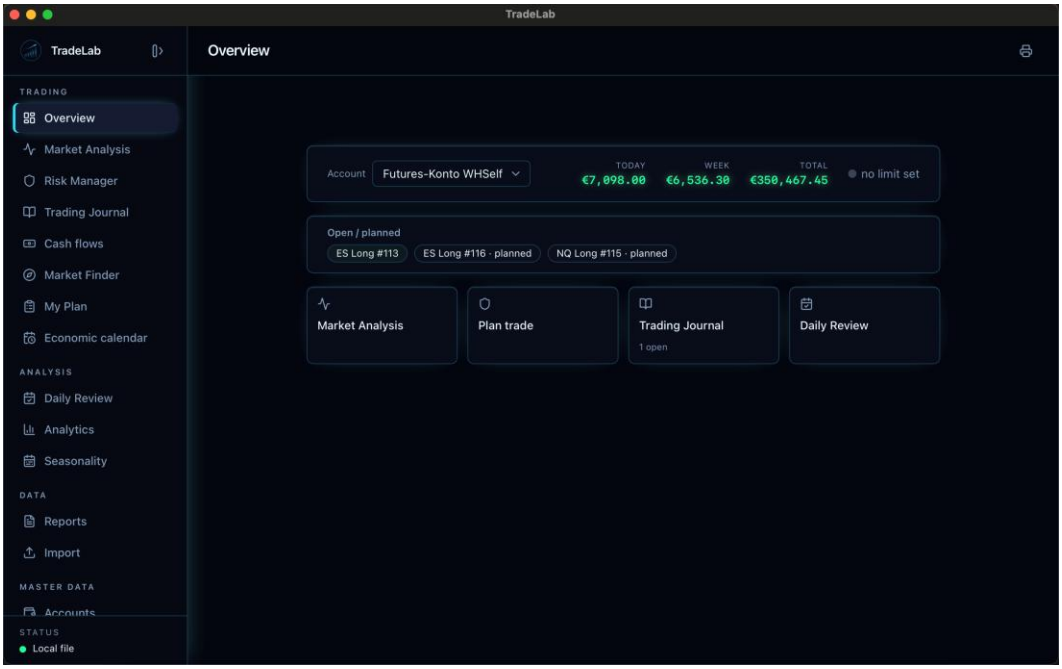
1. Double-click `TradeLab_…_x64-setup.exe` (or `TradeLab-Demo_…`). **No administrator rights** are needed – TradeLab installs for your user only.
2. If Windows shows "Windows protected your PC": click **"More info"** and then **"Run anyway"**. The warning appears because the app does not (yet) have a paid publisher certificate – it is not dangerous.
3. After installation, start TradeLab from the Start menu or the desktop shortcut.

2.2 macOS

1. Open the `.dmg` and drag TradeLab into **Applications**.
2. On first launch use **right-click → "Open"** and confirm (the app is not yet notarized by Apple).

From now on TradeLab updates itself – you never have to download a new file again (see chapter "Updates, backups & safety"). All data stays local on your machine; no cloud required.

3. Your first trade in three steps

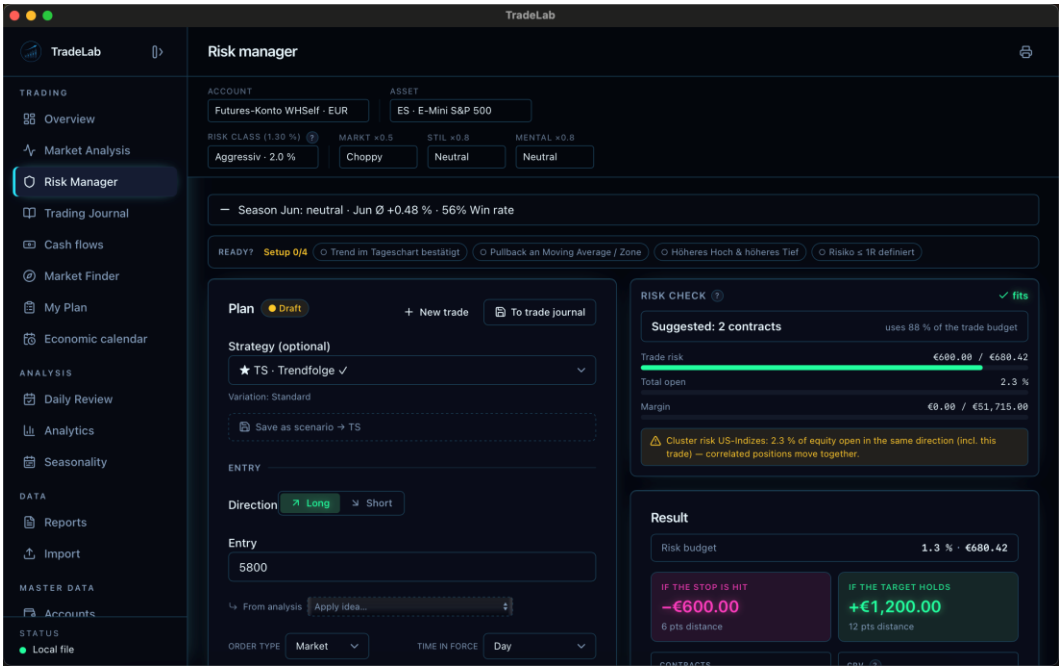


The overview is your starting point: pick an account, see KPIs, jump onward quickly.

Step 1 – Create an account. Master data → Accounts → "+ Account". Name, currency and balance are enough. (Funded/prop accounts can add drawdown rules.)

Step 2 – Create an instrument. Master data → Instruments → "+". Pick a **template** from the catalog (e.g. ES, NQ, FDAX, CL, Gold) – it fills tick size and tick value automatically. Required fields are marked with a red *.

Step 3 – Plan a trade. In the **risk manager** enter direction, entry and stop. TradeLab computes the position size from your risk percentage and shows the outcome preview. “To journal” stores the planned trade.



The risk manager computes position size from risk-% and stop distance – with margin and heat checks.

4. The daily routine

- **Prepare:** check market analysis + economic calendar, assess your mental state honestly.
- **Plan:** compute the setup in the risk manager, risk ≤ 1 R.
- **Record:** every trade into the journal (planned → open → closed) or log directly via “+ Trade”.
- **Close:** fill in the daily review in the evening.
- **Analyze:** spot patterns in Analytics; print/export in Reports.

5. Where do I find what?

- **Market analysis / Risk manager / Trading journal** – the before-during-after core.
- **Analytics** – statistics & analysis (win rate, R-multiple, behavior, AI coach).
- **Reports** – tax, yearly, monthly, weekly, daily report.
- **Settings** – language (DE/EN), theme, modules, AI, backup.

Tip: throughout the app, “?” icons explain the terms right where they appear.

6. What makes TradeLab different

Most trading journals record trades AFTER they happened. TradeLab flips that: it accompanies the whole arc – from market analysis through risk and position planning to analytics. The key difference is the risk manager, which tells you BEFORE you enter how large your position may be and what happens in the best and worst case. Everything runs locally on your machine; your data is yours.

The following chapters explain the features in plain language and reveals the key formulas, so you not only SEE what the app computes but understand WHY.

6.1 The workflow arc — how it all fits together

TradeLab accompanies every trade in five steps. Once you have internalized this arc, you'll find every feature in its right place – the following chapters follow exactly this order:

From idea to review

- Step 1 — Market analysis: assess the situation (SQ per timeframe, market cockpit, levels).
- Step 2 — Risk manager: plan the position (size, stop/target, trade manager, risk check).
- Step 3 — Trading journal: run the trade (planned → open → closed) or reconcile via broker import.
- Step 4 — Analytics: evaluate the results (key figures, behavior, execution quality).
- Step 5 — Daily review: close the trading day with discipline and learn from it.

The master data (account, instrument, strategy) sits before this arc: it is the basis all calculations build on. Sections not needed to get started are marked **Pro** – you can skip them on a first read.

6.2 The dashboard: your situation room

On launch you land on the dashboard. It condenses the current state per account: balance and performance, the most recent trades, open positions and – for funded accounts – progress toward the profit target and the distance to the drawdown limit. From here you navigate into the individual areas via the sidebar. The dashboard computes nothing new; it merely bundles what was captured elsewhere – a quick glance, not a mandatory step.

6.3 Keyboard shortcuts & quick navigation

Instead of clicking, you can jump anywhere: press **g** first, then the matching letter.

Quick navigation (g + letter)

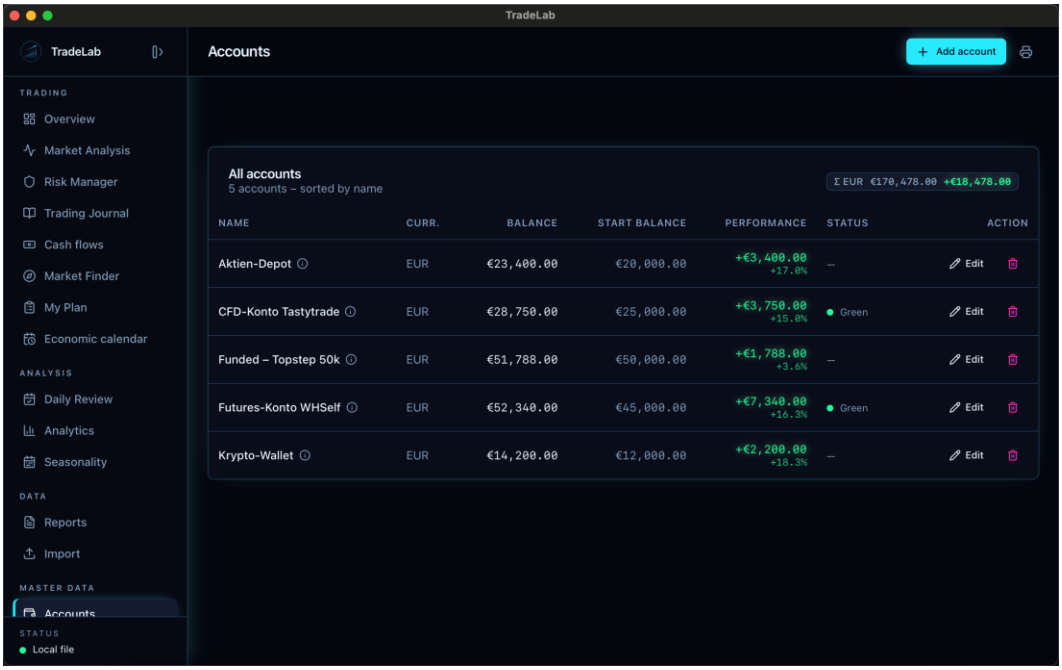
- g d — Overview (dashboard)
- g m — Market analysis
- g r — Risk manager
- g b — Trading journal
- g a — Analytics
- g f — Market finder
- g p — My plan
- g v — Daily review
- g c — Cash flows
- g k — Economic calendar
- g e — Settings

? opens this shortcut overview right inside the app at any time, **Esc** closes dialogs and detail views. That way you can move through TradeLab entirely without a mouse.

7. Master data: the foundation

Before planning you need three things: an account, an instrument and (optionally) a strategy. This master data determines how all later calculations turn out – especially the tick values, which translate price movement into money.

7.1 Creating accounts



The accounts page shows balance, performance and status per account, including a funded account.

This is how you create an account:

1. Go to **Master data → Accounts** and click **"+ Account"**.
2. Enter **name**, **currency** and the **starting balance**. The current balance is carried forward continuously from it and your trades.
3. Optional: set **loss limits** (day/week/month) as a circuit breaker and **discipline goals** (daily target, maximum trades per day).
4. For a prop-firm account pick the account kind **"funded"** and enter provider, phase, account size, profit target and drawdown model (details in chapter "Funded accounts").

7.2 Instruments and the tick value

Every instrument needs a **tick size** (smallest price step) and a **tick value** (money value of one tick per contract) – together they translate price movement into money:

```
P&L = ((exit − entry) ÷ tick size) × tick value × quantity   (for long; short reversed)
```

That's why they are required fields. This is how you create an instrument:

1. Under **Master data → Instruments** click **"+ Instrument"**.

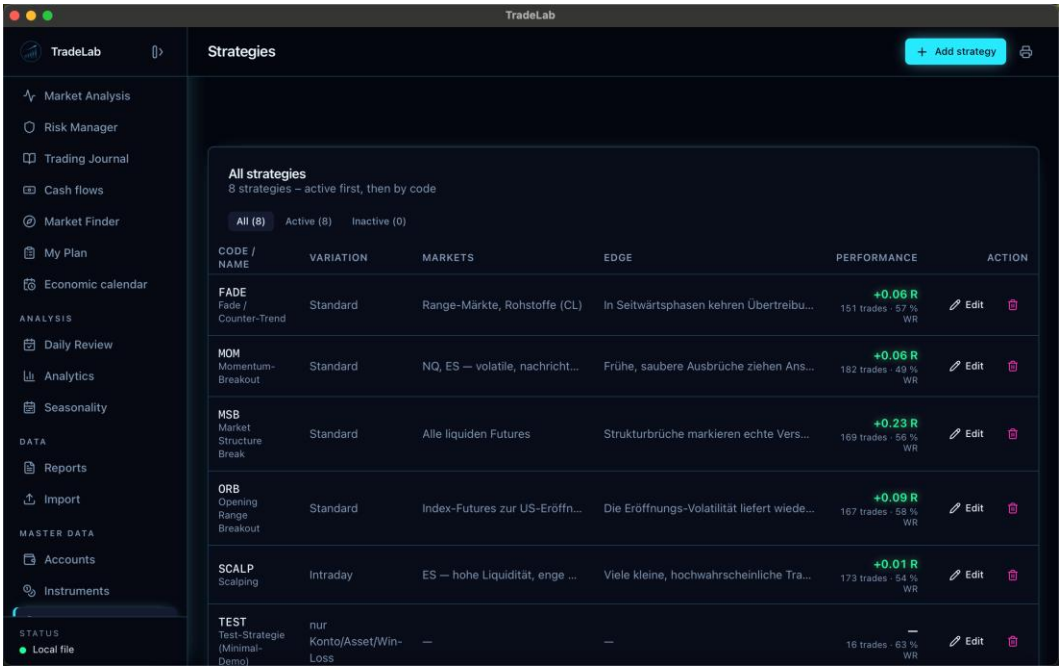
2. Fastest route: pick a **template** from the catalog at the top (16 common futures) – tick size, tick value, exchange and currency are prefilled correctly.

3. Otherwise enter tick size and tick value by hand. As a sanity check the form shows “1 point = X € per contract” – so you spot transposed digits immediately.

4. For options pick the asset type **“option”**; for the seasonality tool you can optionally store a Yahoo symbol.

You can also import whole CFD and futures lists as a file instead of creating every asset one by one.

7.3 Strategies & scenarios

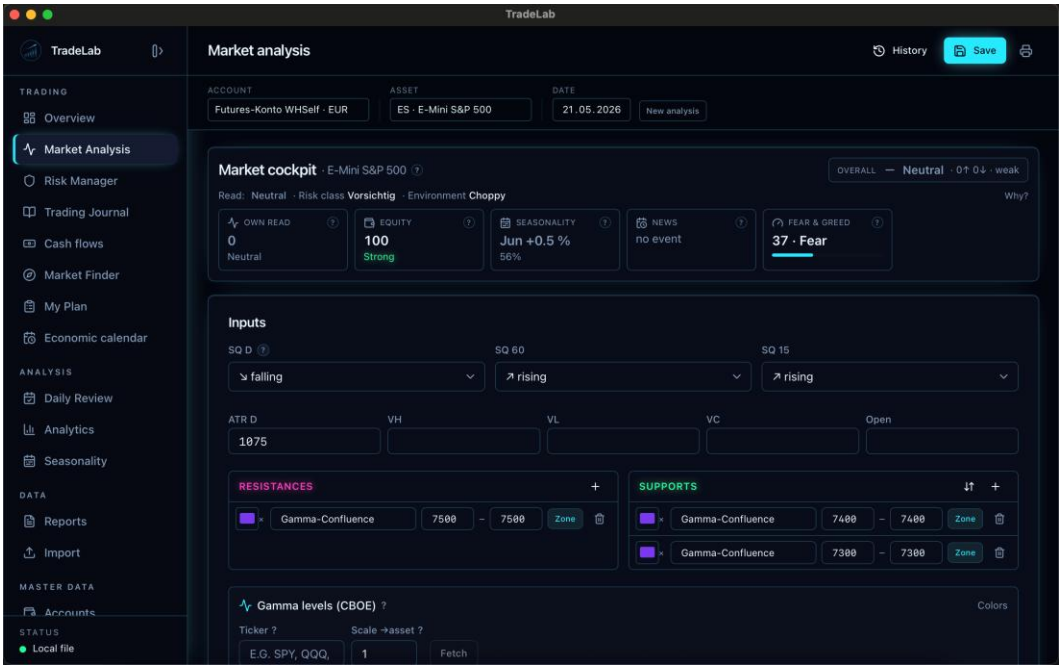


Strategies page: a strategy with directional bias and regime, with named scenario templates below.

A strategy is your named rule set – with a directional preference (long/short/both) and the market regime it works in (trend, range …). Within a strategy you create **scenarios**: named playbook templates that bundle direction, a stop/target rule, a management-phase preset (e.g. break-even + trailing) and notes.

The benefit shows in the risk manager: there you pick a scenario below the strategy field and the app **prefills the plan** – direction, stop/target ideas and management phases. Everything stays editable; nothing is booked automatically. So you cast a strategy you've thought through once into a reusable template instead of rebuilding it every time.

8. Market analysis & market cockpit



Market analysis with the market cockpit, the SQ inputs for three freely nameable timeframes, ATR and levels.

Here you assess the situation before you plan. At the top you pick account and asset, below sits the market cockpit, in the middle the inputs (SQ, ATR, prices), on the right the levels. This is how you fill in an analysis:

1. For each of the three **timeframes** pick your strength read (SQ) from the dropdown: from “falling strongly” through “sideways” to “rising strongly” – internally a scale from −100 to +100. The timeframes default to day, 60 minutes and 15 minutes but are **freely nameable** in the settings (e.g. Weekly / Daily / 4h).
2. Enter the **ATR** (average daily range) and – if you have them – the previous day's high/low/close and the current price. From these the app derives the aggressiveness, among other things.
3. On the right create your **levels** (resistances and supports, optionally as a zone). They reappear later as orientation in the risk manager.
4. Once the three SQ values are set, the app shows the **advantage** at the top – a weighted consensus across the timeframes from −100 to +100. Don't forget to save; the analysis is tied to asset + date.

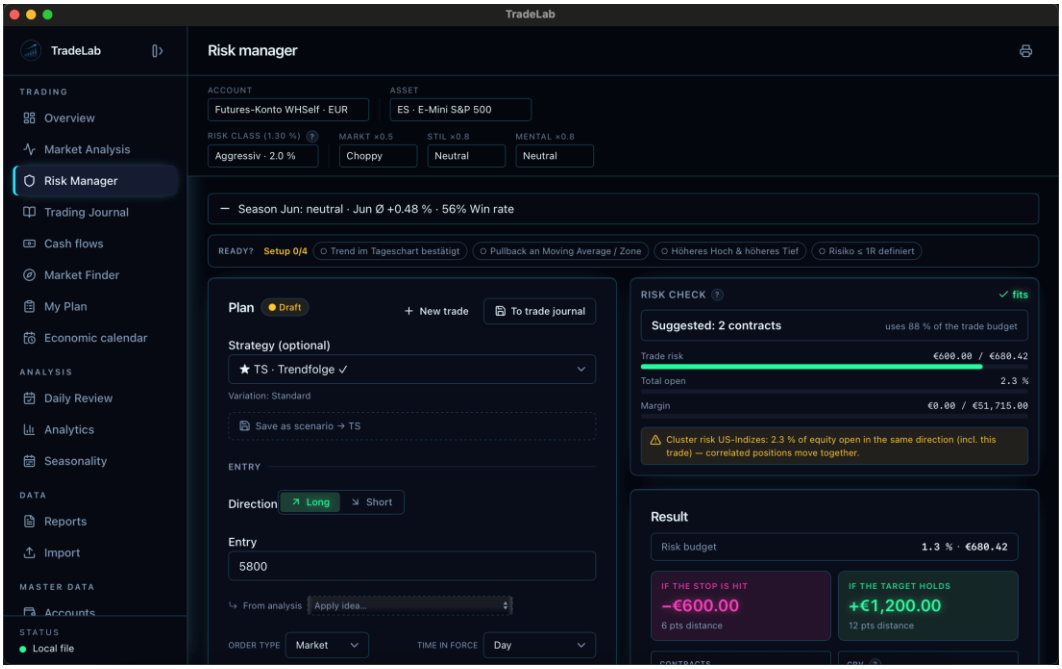
This is how the advantage is computed:

```
advantage = w₁·SQ₁ + w₂·SQ₂ + w₃·SQ₃   (default weights 0.5 / 0.3 / 0.2; clamped to −100…+100)
```

If all three timeframes point the same way there is a clarity bonus (×1.2); if the longest and the shortest unit contradict each other, a penalty (×0.6). The weights as well as bonus/penalty can be adjusted in the settings.

Above the inputs sits the **market cockpit** (top of the first screenshot): four tiles (your own read/advantage · season · news · Fear&Greed) condensed into one overall read. Clicking a tile takes you to the matching detail page. The idea behind it is **confluence**: several independent signals pointing the same way are stronger than any single one – a “?” on each tile explains what it measures.

9. Risk manager: step by step to a position



Risk manager: the header at the top, the "Ready?" bar, the plan in three blocks on the left, risk check and outcome on the right.

The risk manager is the heart of the app: here you finish planning the position BEFORE you enter it. The page is laid out like this: **at the very top** the header with account, asset, risk budget and risk class; **below it** the "Ready?" bar with two check groups; **on the left** the plan in three blocks (① entry, ② stop & target, ③ management); **on the right** the risk check and the outcome preview; **at the very bottom** the dynamic plan as a timeline. We'll walk through everything in order – first the core flow:

1. At the very top pick your **account** and the **asset**. Next to them your **risk budget** appears – the amount of money you are willing to lose at most on this trade.
2. Set the **risk class** (e.g. 1 %). It determines what share of your balance the risk budget is: risk budget = balance × risk-%.
3. In block ① **Entry** pick the **direction** (long/short) and enter your planned price into the **Entry** field. (Optionally pick a **strategy** and a **scenario** above it – the app then prefills stop and target ideas.)
4. In block ② **Stop & target** enter the **stop** – as a price, as a tick distance or in % – and, if you have one, the **target**.
5. As soon as entry and stop are set, the **outcome appears on the right**: the number of **contracts**, your risk in **€ and R**, the preview "if the stop hits" (loss) and "if the target holds" (profit), plus the required **margin** and the **heat** (simultaneously open risk).
6. If the **risk check** is green, click **"To journal"**. The **Next step** line tells you exactly what follows: first place the order with your broker, then activate the trade in the journal once it is filled.

Behind the scenes the app computes the position size like this – you don't have to do it yourself, but this is how you can verify it:

```
risk per contract = (|entry − stop| ÷ tick size) × tick value
contracts = risk budget ÷ risk per contract   (rounded down)
```

If something is off, the **risk check** tells you why – for instance when the position needs more margin than is free, the heat exceeds your limit or (on funded accounts) a drawdown rule would be violated.

9.1 The trade manager: actively managing the position

Optionally you plan right here how you want to manage the position AFTER entry. This is how you add a rule:

1. Below the plan click **"+ new action"**.
2. Pick the action type from the **dropdown** (the six types are described below).
3. Enter its **trigger** – usually a distance in ticks from the entry.
4. The app factors the action in **immediately**: stop, quantity and secured profit change visibly, before you even run the trade.

These are the six types you can choose from:

Pyramid (add in profit). If the trade runs your way, you scale the position up. You specify from how many ticks in profit (trigger) how many contracts are added. That way you only increase your stake when the market is already proving you right – the average entry shifts accordingly.

Scale-out / partial sell. The counterpart: at an interim target you take part of the position off the table and let the rest run. You set the trigger (profit distance) and the quantity to reduce. That locks in realized profit without closing the whole position.

Average-down. Here you add when the price runs AGAINST you, to lower the average entry. This is deliberately the riskiest action – it grows the position while it is losing. The app therefore flags it as a loss trigger and warns when it pushes your risk beyond the budget.

Break-even (protect the trade). Once the trade has a lead you choose, the app pulls the stop to the entry (optionally a few ticks above it). From that point the trade can no longer turn negative in the worst case – a risk trade becomes a "free" trade.

Trailing / max-profit (protect the profit). The stop follows the price – either at a fixed tick distance or as a multiple of the ATR. That way you secure more and more of the accumulated profit without watching the trade by hand; the trade runs until the trailed stop is hit.

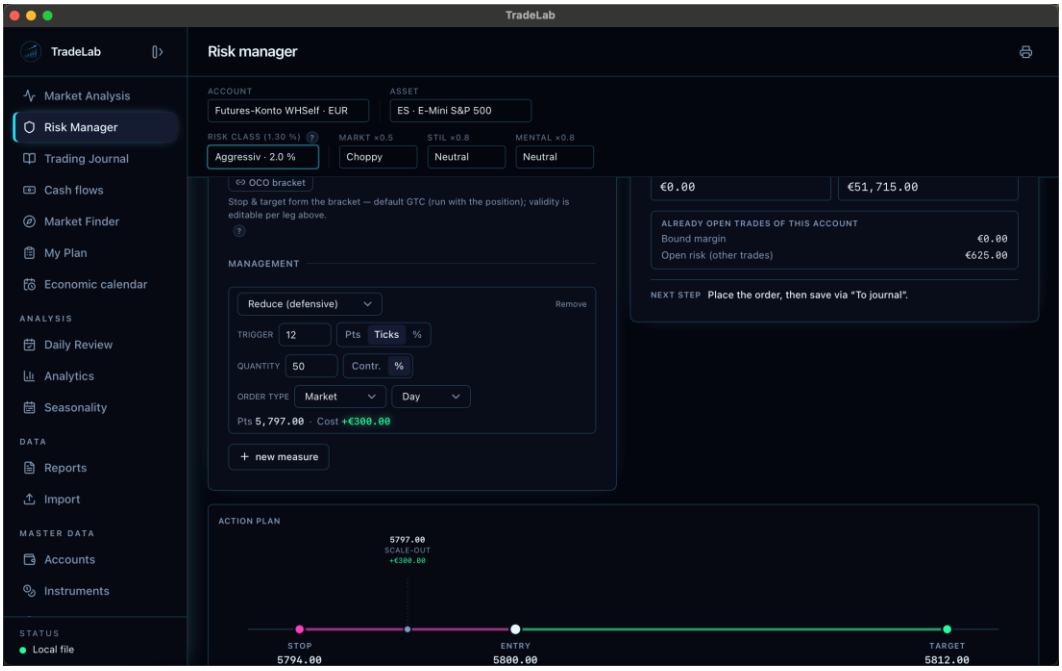
Combined protection. As soon as you combine pyramid and break-even/trailing, the app treats the base position and the add-ons as ONE combined position and computes from which price which profit – in euros AND in R – is guaranteed to be secured. It also warns when an add-on is still unprotected or the stop still sits in the loss zone.

Circuit breaker. If you have stored loss limits (day/week/month) on the account, a banner in the risk manager shows a traffic light. Once a limit is reached, the app blocks booking into the journal – softly, with an explicit "Continue anyway". That protects you from the classic mistake of overtrading in a spin after a losing streak.

9.2 Readiness checks, dynamic plan and risk check

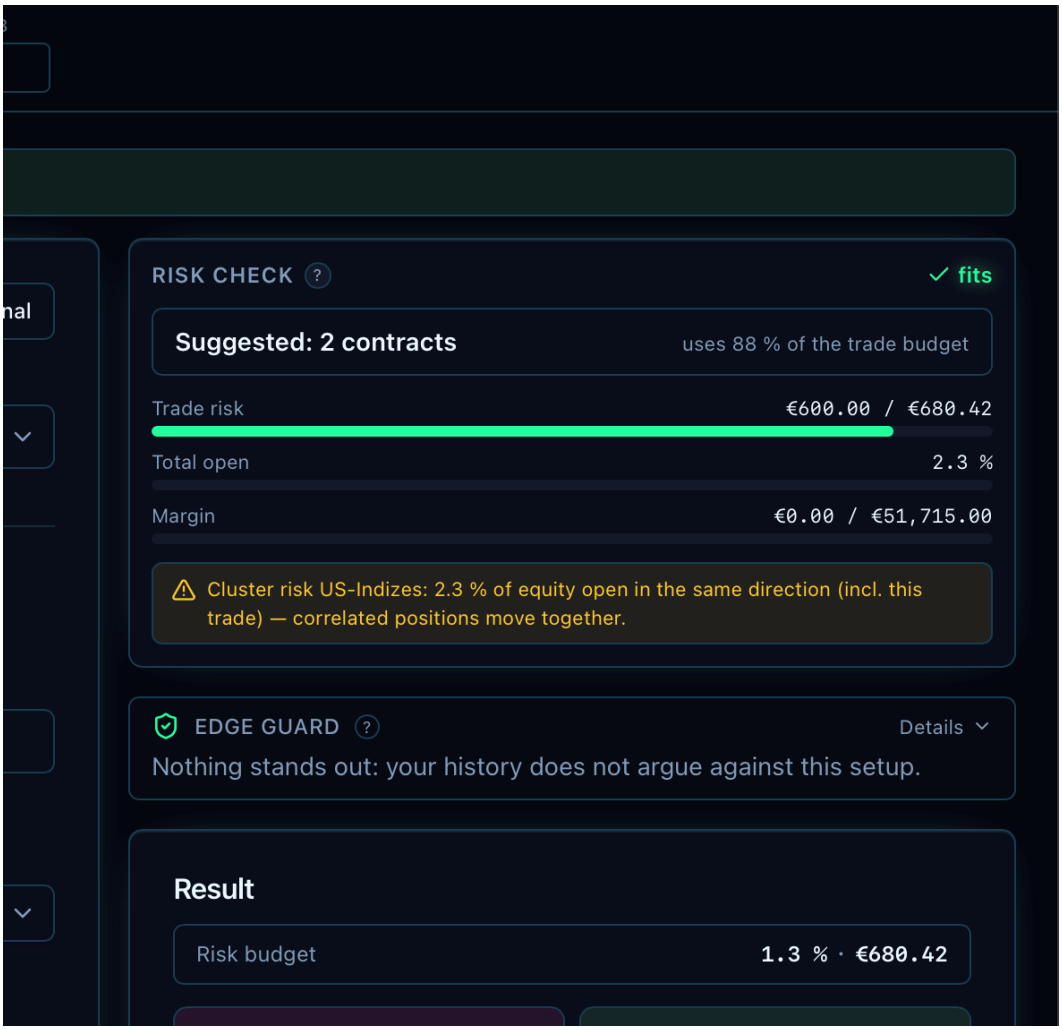
Around the plan the page shows further building blocks that help you stay disciplined:

The “Ready?” bar (top). Two groups of clickable checkmarks: **Setup** is your pre-trade checklist from the selected strategy (e.g. “trend on the daily chart”, “volume confirms”), **Head** is your mental checklist (e.g. “well rested”, “no revenge trade”). Tick what applies before you book – the checkmarks are stored with the trade and later feed into the discipline analysis.



The dynamic action plan: stop · entry · target on one line, management phases as markers — updates live.

The dynamic plan (timeline, at the very bottom). Here you see your plan as a graphic: entry, stop, target and every management phase on one line. The special part: the graphic **updates live** while you type. Change the stop or add an action, and the line shifts immediately – so you see at a glance how the planned path changes, without booking anything.

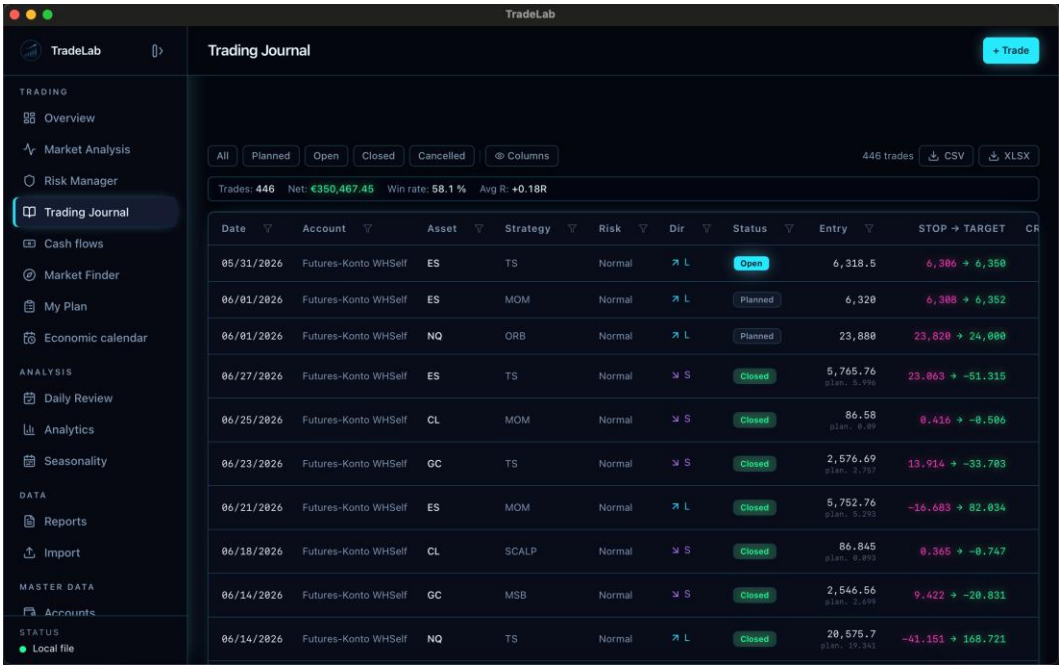


Risk check and outcome: verdict light, recommended contracts, trade risk, margin and heat.

The risk check (top right). A traffic light with a short verdict sums up whether your plan is within bounds: green means “fine”, yellow and red signal that something is violated – too much risk for the budget, more margin than is free, heat above your limit or a loss limit that has been reached. The **“?”** next to the verdict explains the light in detail. Rule of thumb: only book on green.

The outcome panel (below it on the right). It bundles all the numbers of your plan: **contracts**, the risk in **€ and R**, the required **margin** (intraday and overnight), the **heat**, plus the two ends “if the stop hits” and “if the target holds”. At the very bottom sits the **Next step** line, which walks you through placing, saving and activating the order.

10. Trading journal & import

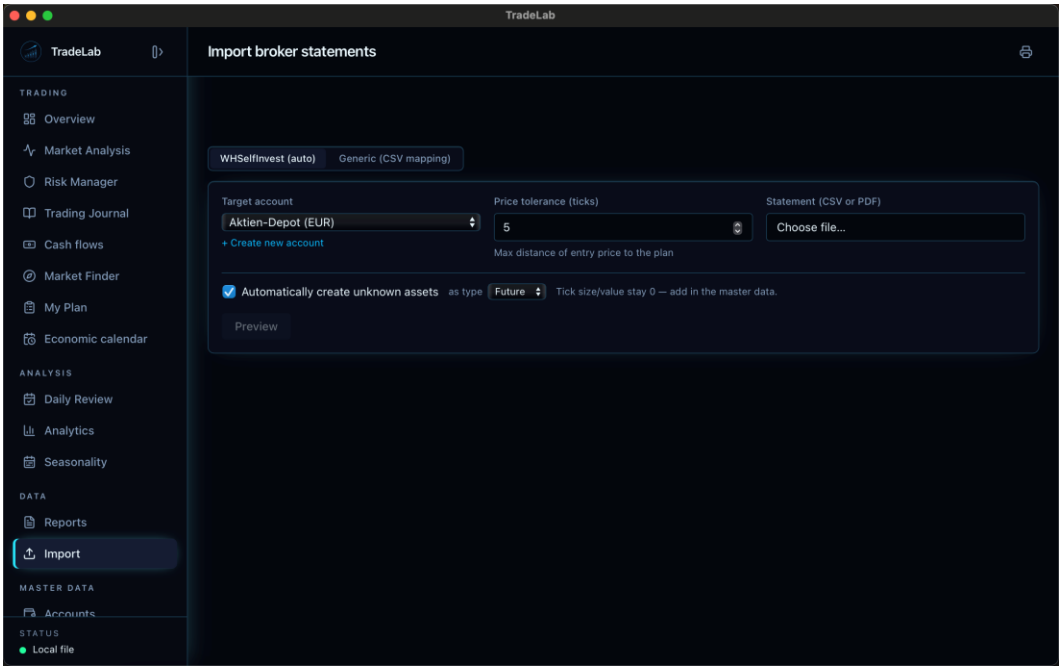


The journal with the account filter in the header, status quick filters, column picker and CSV/XLSX export.

The journal is your complete history. At the top you filter by **account** (dropdown in the header) and by status (All · Planned · Open · Closed · Cancelled); via **“Columns”** you show and hide columns, and on the right you export as CSV or XLSX. Each column also carries a small funnel for a fine filter – when filters are active, a “Clear filters” appears in the header.

Every trade goes through three states: **planned → open → closed**. You start the full lifecycle in the risk manager (“To journal”), activate it on entry and close it on exit. For quick after-the-fact logging there is **“+ Trade”**: it records a trade in one step – planned, open or already closed, with a date.

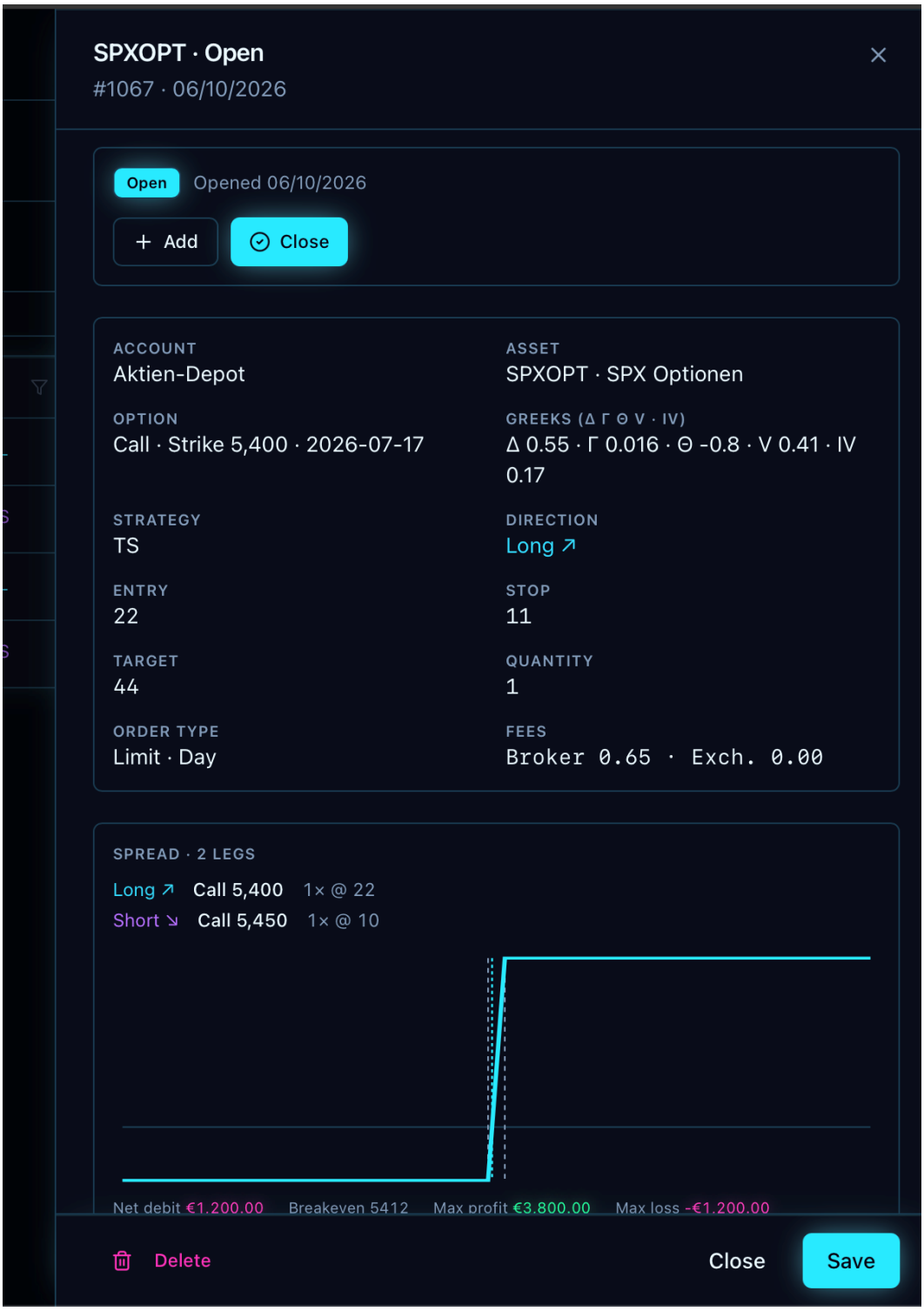
A **click on a row** opens the detail view. There you see the whole context of a trade bundled: plan, setup checklist, management actions, linked cash flows, the daily review and – for options – greeks including the payoff profile. **Partial exits (scale-out)** are recorded per tranche; the trade row remains the summary of the whole position. Imported trades are read-only so the broker record stays untouched.



Import: WHSelfInvest (CSV/PDF) or generic CSV mapping, with target account and price basis.

You import broker statements as CSV/PDF. An import is matched to a planned/open manual trade if asset and direction match and the entry price is within tolerance (tolerance = ticks × tick size).

10.1 Options & multi-leg spreads (Pro)

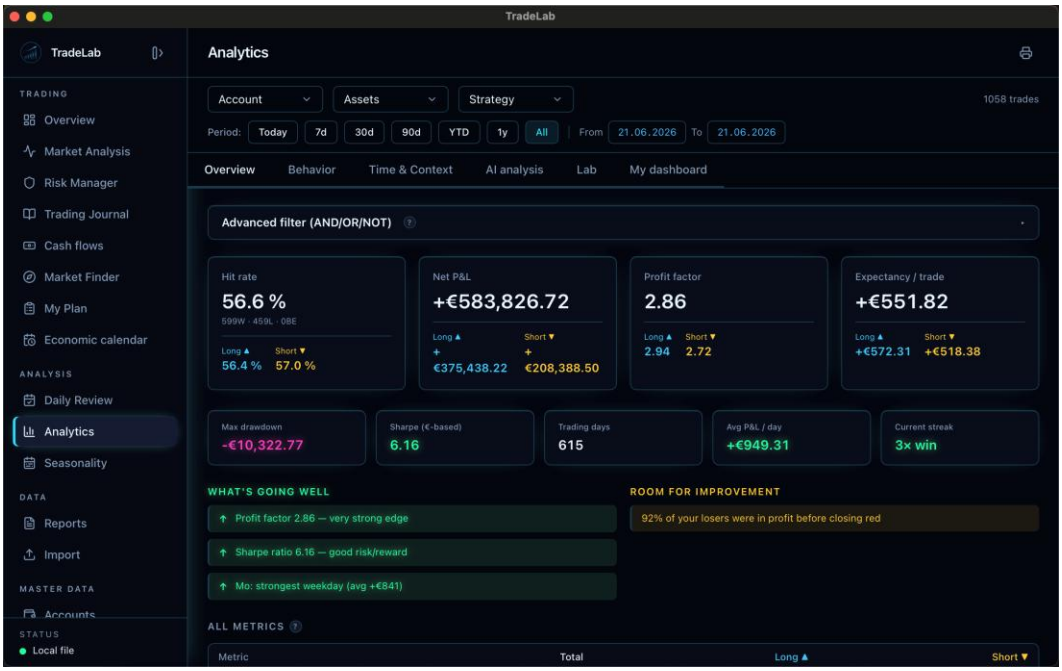


Options trade with right/strike/expiry and greeks; on the right the spread's payoff profile.

For options you additionally capture type (call/put), strike and expiry, plus optionally the greeks (delta, gamma, theta, vega, IV). The value at expiry is shown by the **payoff profile**: break-even is at strike + premium for a call, strike − premium for a put.

Several legs that together form one position (e.g. a spread) share a common id – their P&L is summed so the analysis sees the spread as ONE position. The link type controls how the legs relate: single, OCO (either/or), parallel or laddered. The spread analysis in the “Behavior” tab compares single vs. multi-leg trades per link type.

11. Analytics – and how the metrics arise



Analytics, “Overview” tab: the key metrics at a glance.

The analytics page bundles everything your closed trades can teach you. At the very top you pick account and period – these filters apply to **all** analyses at once. Below sit several tabs: **Overview** (the key metrics), **Time** (weekday, hour, month, season), **Behavior** (statistically tested patterns), **AI analysis** and **Lab** (pro tools). We'll go through them in order and explain every metric in plain words – no statistics background required.

The **Overview** tab starts with four big tiles. Each shows a total at the top and the same value split for long and short trades below – so you see right away whether you e.g. only make money on the long side. The four tiles are: **win rate**, **net P&L** (your result after fees), **profit factor** and **expectancy**. A small “?” on a tile opens a short explanation.

The **win rate** counts only decided trades; break-even trades (net exactly 0) count as neither win nor loss:

```
win rate = winners ÷ (winners + losers)
```

Break-even as its own class is usually small: after fees a stop pulled to break-even often lands as a tiny plus or minus. How often your break-even stop actually triggered is therefore shown most honestly under the exit reason (Overview tab → exit reason), not in the break-even win rate.

Expectancy says what an average trade yields over the long run:

```
expectancy = win rate × avg win − (1 − win rate) × avg loss
```

The profit factor relates wins to losses (> 1 = profitable):

```
profit factor = Σ wins ÷ | Σ losses |
```

A profit factor of 1.5 means: for every euro lost, €1.50 is gained. Values from about 1.3 count as solid; below 1.0 you lose on balance. The **expectancy** is the most practical of the four numbers – it says what an average trade brings in over the long run; a positive expectancy is the precondition for trading being worthwhile at all.

Below the tiles the overview shows several charts: **streak chips** (your longest winning and losing streak), a **dot chart** (every dot one trade, green or red, its height the profit/loss), the **drawdown curve** (how far your account temporarily fell below its last high – the "pain" you sat through) and an **insights box** that automatically sums up the three strongest and three weakest patterns in plain language. So you never have to compute anything yourself – the app states on its own where your money comes from and where it gets lost.

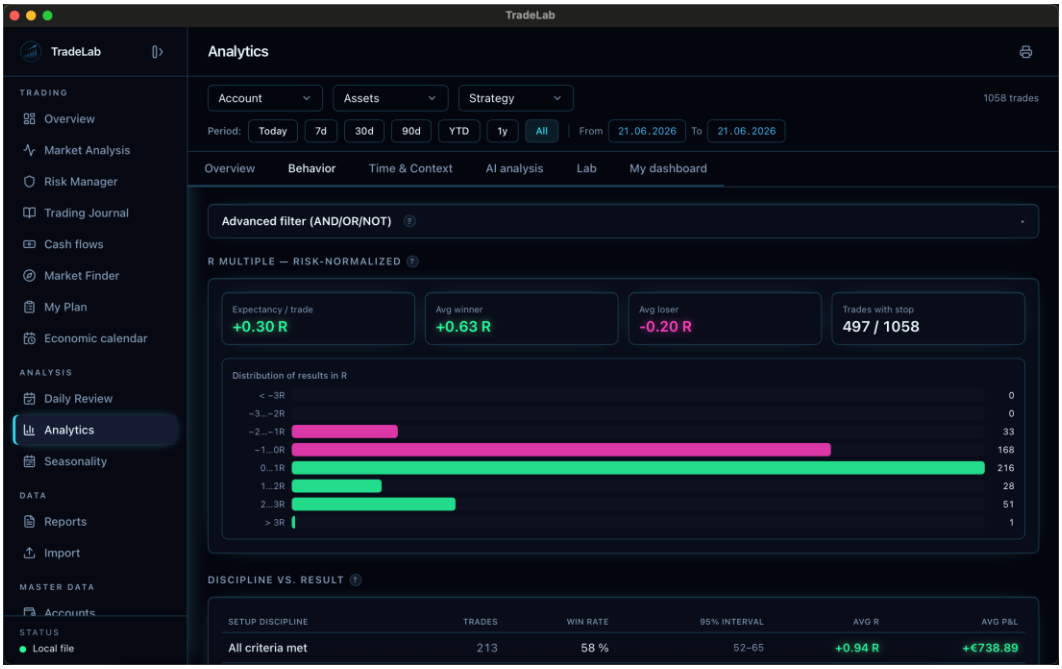
11.1 R-multiple – thinking risk-normalized

Euro amounts are hard to compare because trades differ in size. The R-multiple normalizes the result to the risk originally taken (1 R = your initial risk):

```
initial risk = (|entry − stop| ÷ tick size) × tick value × quantity
R-multiple = realized P&L ÷ initial risk
```

A trade at +2 R earned twice the risk – regardless of whether that was much or little in euros. Expectancy in R is the most honest metric for your edge. Without a stop there is no defined risk and thus no R.

11.2 The "Behavior" tab – statistically honest



Behavior: R-multiple distribution and the discipline table with 95% Wilson interval.

On small samples a win rate of "60 %" means little when it rests on ten trades – with a bit of bad luck you would have gotten the same six hits by pure chance. That is exactly where the **Behavior** tab comes in: it tests whether a pattern (e.g. "Fridays go better") is real or just chance. So you can read the displays, here are the three terms that keep coming up – in plain words:

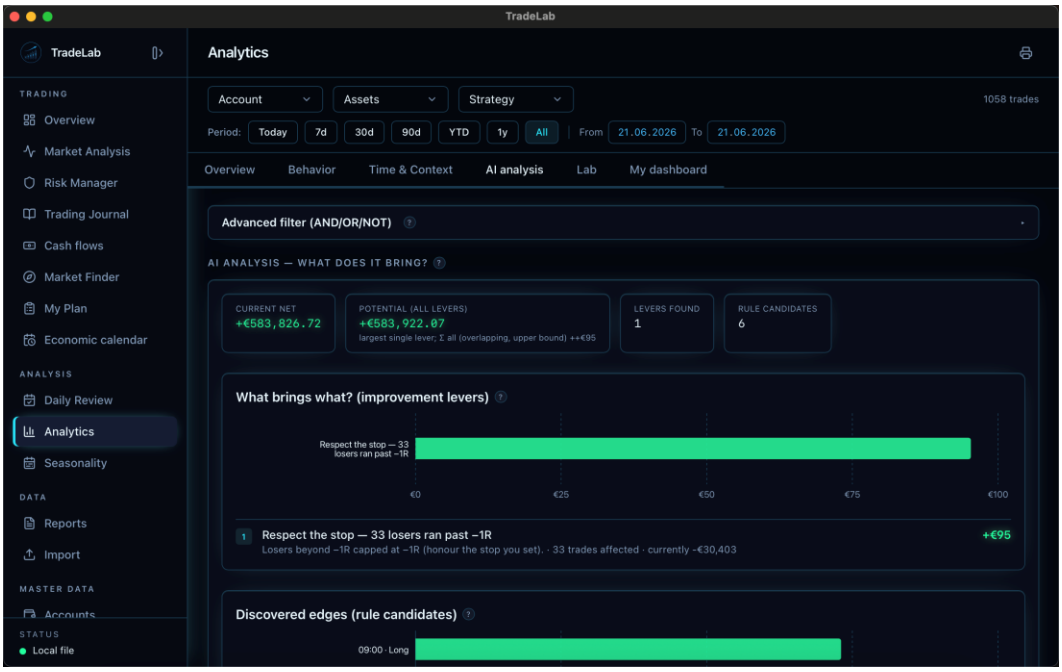
Statistics in plain words

• Confidence interval (Wilson): the honest range of a rate. “55 % (40–69 %)” means: the true value very likely lies somewhere between 40 and 69 % – with few trades this band is wide, with many it narrows.
• p-value: the probability that a found difference is pure chance. Small (below 0.05) = unlikely to be chance = worth taking seriously. Large = could well be chance.
• Bonferroni: test many things at once and you will almost always find “something” by chance. Bonferroni tightens the threshold the more is tested – a guard against false conclusions.
That's why the app only labels a pattern **robust** when the p-value is small enough (also after Bonferroni); otherwise it is explicitly called **exploratory** – an interesting lead to keep watching, but not to take at face value yet. This way chance is never sold to you as an “edge”.

Two more values you meet here: **MAE** (maximum adverse excursion) is the furthest a trade ran AGAINST you before it closed; **MFE** (maximum favorable excursion) the furthest it ran FOR you. From the two you read whether your stops sit too tight (lots of MAE on eventual winners) or whether you leave profits on the table (lots of MFE, but closed small). The **R-multiple distribution** at the top of the tab shows the same idea as a histogram: how many trades made −1 R, +1 R, +2 R …? A healthy trading style has a few big winners on the right that outweigh the many small losers on the left.

Further analyses slice your trades by context: seasonal alignment (with/against the seasonal tendency), news proximity (distance to the nearest high-impact event), ATR regime (volatility at entry, measured as ATR ÷ entry price), confidence calibration (does the win rate rise with the conviction of the analysis?) and month of year. The chapter “The demo version” shows how to read these on example data.

11.3 AI coach & AI analysis



AI analysis: €-quantified improvement levers and discovered rule candidates from your trades.

The AI coach is **data-driven, not invented**: it computes only from your recorded numbers. The “AI analysis” tab shows **improvement levers** with a € effect (e.g. cap losers worse than −1 R at −1 R, weakest weekday, tired trades) and **rule candidates** – patterns like weekday × direction that act like a little strategy of your own.

Statistically honest: only what passes the significance test (with Bonferroni correction) may be called an “edge”; everything else is explicitly “exploratory” – a hypothesis to test, not a proof.

In Settings under “AI” there is also a **chat that knows your trades**: it uses tools to look things up live in your own data – metrics, edges and the most recent trades including notes. You can **attach chart screenshots** – the default model understands text and images alike and reads the chart. There is also an AI analysis for a single trade right in the detail view.

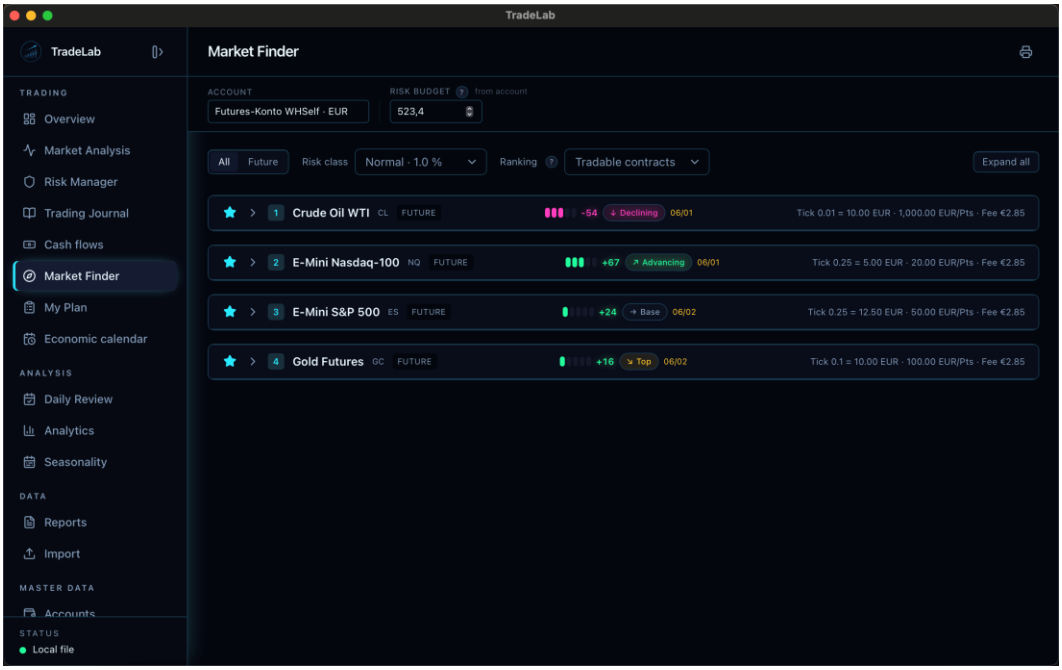
Local & free – your data stays with you

• The default is **Ollama** with the model `qwen3-vl:8b-instruct` (ONE model for text, images and tools): runs fully locally on your machine, free, nothing leaves the device.
• Setting it up takes a few clicks with the in-app assistant (chapter “Setting up the local AI”). Without Ollama the app stays fully usable – only the AI features are missing.
• Cloud providers (Anthropic, OpenAI, Google) are optional with your own key; data then leaves the machine – the app points this out.

12. Further tools

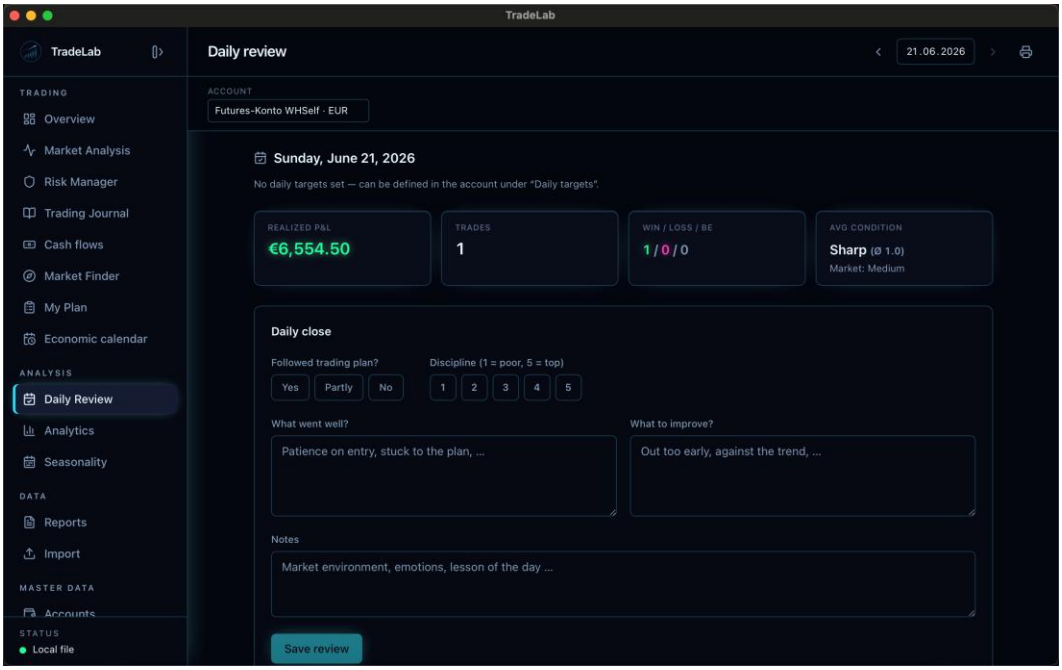
Beyond the core workflow there are several additional tools. Some are optional and can be switched on and off in the settings (“Modules” tab); the most important ones in order:

Cash flows records money movements outside trades – dividends, swap, funding, interest, fees. Per entry you set kind, amount and currency; the account amount follows as amount ÷ FX rate. That way e.g. dividends flow correctly into your account balance and into the tax reports. The page appears automatically as soon as you keep a stock, forex or crypto asset.



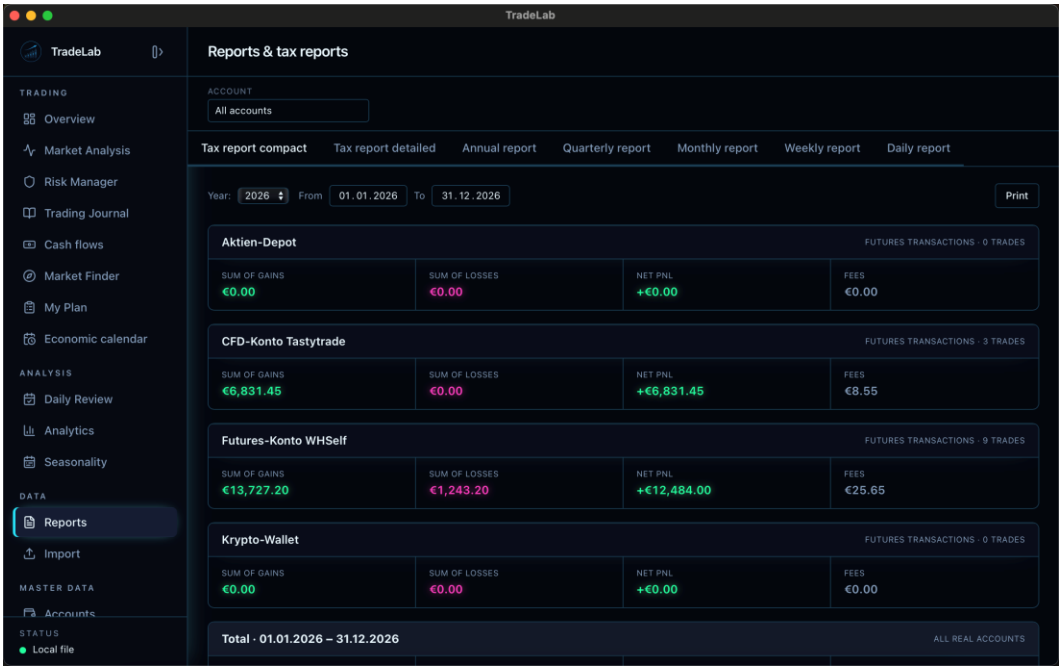
Market finder: ATR ranking with a risk budget per asset.

The market finder ranks your watchlist by movement (ATR) and shows your risk budget per asset right next to it (balance × risk-class-%). So you see at a glance which market is most worthwhile today and how large you could trade there. Via the star you curate which assets appear in the selectors at all.



Daily review: end-of-day close per account with a discipline grade and lesson notes.

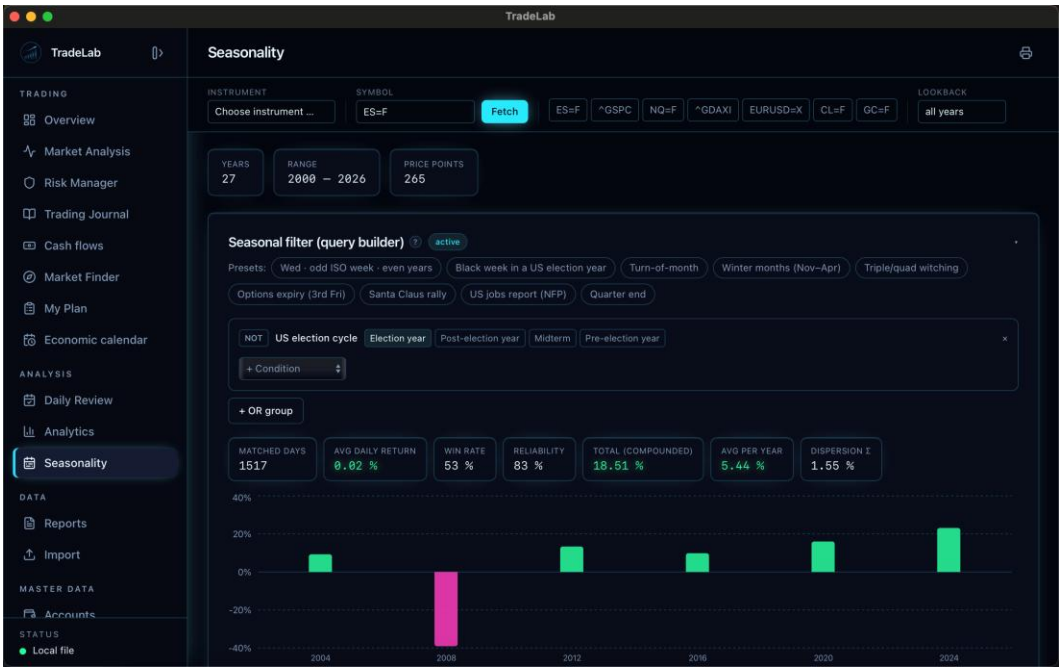
My plan is your written rule set (setups, do's & don'ts, mental checklist) – the mental items reappear in the risk manager's “Ready?” bar. The **daily review** closes the trading day: you pick account and date, rate whether you followed your plan, give yourself a discipline grade and note down what went well and what you want to improve. That is the basis for the later discipline analysis.



Reports: seven reports (tax compact/detailed, year, quarter, month, week, day); print + CSV export.

The **reports** cover tax (compact/detailed, with account selection), year, quarter, month, week and day. Each report can be printed (system print dialog, including “save as PDF”) and exported as CSV; the tax and period reports carry a discipline score and an equity chart.

12.1 Seasonality: recurring patterns



Seasonality: yearly path, percentile bands and the “where am I today” banner.

The seasonality tool (toggle in Settings) shows whether an instrument has recurring calendar patterns. It pulls the price data via the stored Yahoo symbol and splits into four views: **month** (avg return per month), **weekday** (incl. week-of-month and turn-of-month), **window** (a freely chosen date window across the years, with percentile bands P10–P90 and reliability) and **pattern** (yearly path with a percentile tube and a “where am I today” banner). Important: seasonality is a **tendency, not a guarantee** – the app therefore also shows the dispersion. In the market cockpit the seasonal bias feeds in as one of several confluence signals.

12.2 Gamma levels & entry context (Pro)

Gamma levels (optional tool) derive levels such as zero-gamma, walls and max-pain from CBOE options data of proxy tickers and adopt them as levels in the market analysis. The **entry context** stores a snapshot of the situation when a trade is created (advantage, season, news proximity, Fear&Greed, ATR) – collectable forward only. Over time this yields the **context calibration**: was your overall read “in favour” actually successful more often?

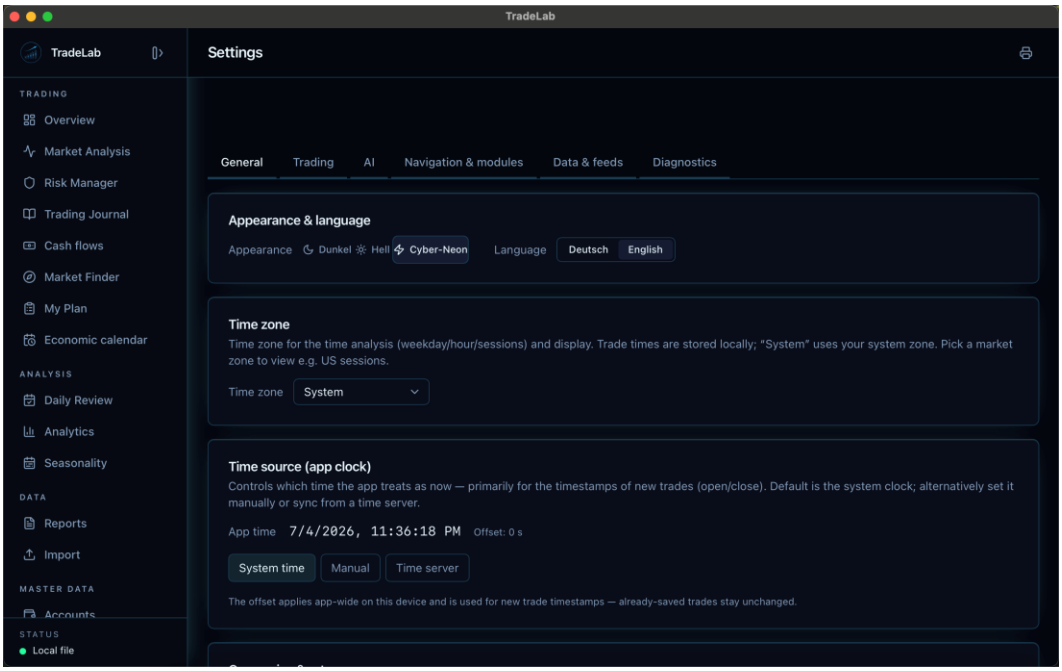
13. Funded accounts: the drawdown models

If you trade for a prop firm, you set the account kind **“funded”** on the account and enter provider, phase, account size, profit target and the drawdown model. It is exactly this drawdown model that decides how strictly your maximum decline is capped – TradeLab knows three variants and factors them into the risk check and the dashboard.

With the **static** model the allowed low sits fixed below the starting capital and never moves – the easiest to handle. With **trailing (EOD)** the limit follows your highest end-of-day balance: when you make profit, the floor moves up with you, but only once per day. With **intraday trailing** the limit even follows every interim high during the day – the strictest model, because even a brief spike permanently raises your floor.

From your balance history the app continuously computes the remaining **buffer to the drawdown limit** and the **progress toward the profit target** and shows both on the dashboard. This is an approximation from your recorded trades – the app clearly marks it as such, so you don't confuse it with the prop firm's official accounting.

14. Settings, backup & AI



The settings are organized into tabs: General, Trading, AI, Modules, Data, Diagnostics.

The settings are organized into tabs. Under **General** you pick language (German/English) and theme (three themes) – number and date formats follow the language automatically – and set the time zone and the app clock. Under **Trading** live the formula weights and the freely nameable SQ timeframes (see chapter “Market analysis & market cockpit”).

Under **Data & feeds** you secure your data: “Export full backup” writes everything into one file, “import” brings it back (e.g. on a new machine); in addition you can export the trades as CSV. The full backup also contains your settings – theme, language, dashboard, data sources and the AI's memory – but deliberately **no API keys**: those stay on each device. Also here: the optional **folder sync** (NAS/iCloud) – the app pulls the latest state on start and pushes it back on quit; on a conflict it asks instead of overwriting anything – as well as the **app updates** (see chapter “Updates, backups & safety”).

Under **AI** you choose provider and model of the AI coach and set up the local AI (separate chapter). What the AI can do is described in section “AI coach & AI analysis”. Under **Navigation & modules** you toggle the optional tools (calendar, gamma, seasonality …), and under **Diagnostics** you find the visual audit and the error log, among other things.

15. Setting up the local AI

By default the AI features run on **Ollama** – a free program that runs AI models directly on your computer. Nothing leaves your device. TradeLab includes an assistant that guides you through the setup in three steps: **Settings → AI → "Set up local AI"**. Each open step has exactly one button; completed steps get a green check mark.

1. **Ollama is installed.** On Windows, "Install Ollama" downloads the official installer, **checks its digital signature** (only an installer validly signed by Ollama Inc. is started) and launches it – you just click through. On macOS the Ollama download page opens.
2. **Ollama is running.** After installation Ollama usually starts by itself (icon in the taskbar notification area or menu bar). TradeLab detects this automatically; otherwise use the "Start Ollama" button.
3. **The model is loaded.** "Load model" fetches the default model (`qwen3-vl:8b-instruct`, approx. 6 GB) with a progress display. It understands text and images – including your chart screenshots.

Once all three checks are green, the AI is ready. Below, the assistant shows the Ollama version and the installed models; **"Pull / update model"** and **"Update Ollama program"** keep both up to date.

Good to know

• If the local AI is selected but not reachable, a hint bar reminds you on start – with a direct jump to the assistant. You can also hide the hint permanently.
• The AI needs computing power: with a graphics card it answers in seconds, without one it can take considerably longer.
• Alternatively you can pick a cloud provider (Anthropic, OpenAI, Google) with your own API key under AI. The requested data then leaves the machine – the app points this out.
• For images the AI accepts PNG, JPEG, GIF and WebP.

16. Updates, backups & safety

TradeLab may hold important figures about your money. That is why the app is built so that an update or an error **never loses data** – and there is always a way back.

16.1 Updates

On start, TradeLab quietly checks whether a new version exists and then shows it under **Settings → Data & feeds → App updates** (you can also "Check for updates" yourself there). **"Update now"** runs everything automatically in this order:

1. **Download and verify:** every update is digitally signed. If the signature does not match – e.g. because the file is damaged or tampered with – it is **not** installed.
2. **Back up:** before installing, the app checks your database and creates a complete, verified backup.
3. **Install:** TradeLab installs the new version and restarts.
4. **Verify again:** after the restart the app checks that all data is complete and intact. A green bar confirms the successful update.

16.2 Update channel: stable or beta

The default is **Stable** – you only get versions that were tested beforehand. If you want new features earlier, switch to **Beta** under App updates. Beta versions are less tested; the setting applies to this device only.

16.3 Back to the previous version

If something is wrong after an update, App updates offers the button **“Back to version …”**. It goes back exactly one step – to the version you last updated from. Beforehand the app shows what happens to your data: if the data structure has not changed (the normal case), **all data is kept**. Otherwise it restores the backup from before the update; anything you entered since is saved separately first. The version you went back from is not offered to you again – only the next one.

16.4 Automatic backups

Independently of updates, TradeLab creates a **verified backup every day** and keeps the last 7 daily and 4 weekly backups; in addition before every update and every database upgrade. Under App updates you see when the last backup ran, and **“Open backups folder”** opens the folder. These backups do not replace a full backup on another drive – you should still export that regularly.

16.5 Check on every start

On every start TradeLab checks the database. If it finds a problem, a **recovery page** opens instead of the normal interface: there you can restore a backup (e.g. the one from before the last update), go back to the previous version or – for harmless findings – continue anyway. Before a backup is restored, the app saves the current state, so this step can be undone as well.

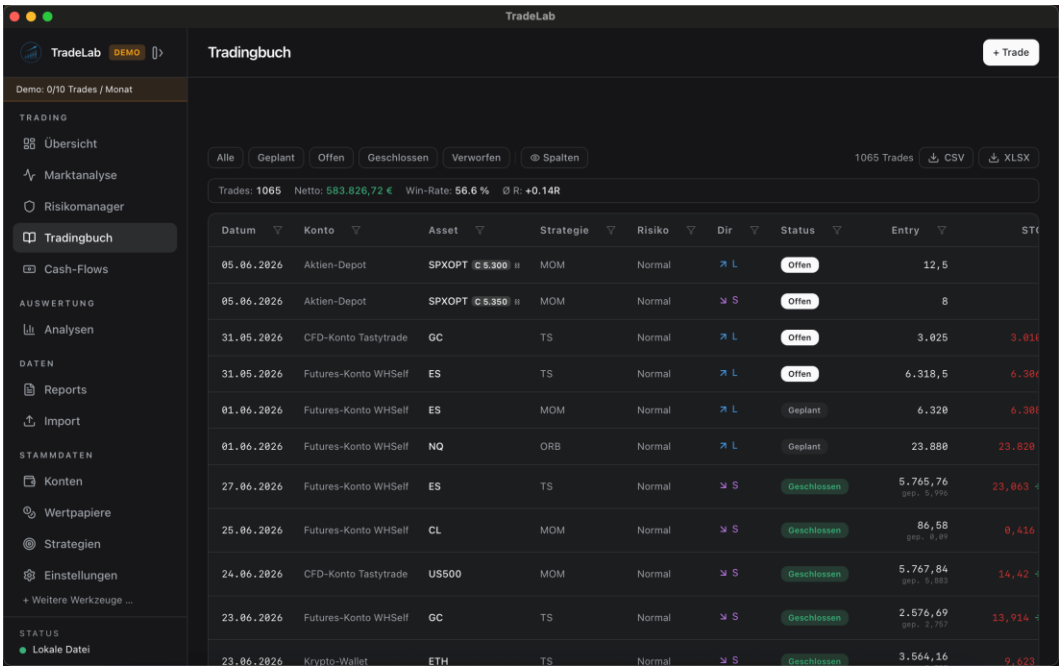
17. The demo version

17.1 What is the demo version?

This demo shows what TradeLab can do – with over 1,000 pre-filled, realistic sample trades. It is fully functional but deliberately limited compared with the full version:

- **Max. 10 new trades per month** (the demo data does NOT count – only what you add yourself).
- The **AI features** are optional; without Ollama installed a placeholder is shown. All analyses work regardless.

- Everything else is unlocked: all pages, analyses, reports, import/export.



Demo marking in the sidebar: the "Demo" badge + the remaining quota "X/10 trades this month".

This chapter explains the **logic behind the demo data** and **how to read the analyses** – so you see what minimal vs. fully maintained data yields.

17.2 The demo data at a glance

Five accounts each demonstrate one asset class: a futures account (ES, NQ, CL, Gold), a CFD account (US500, DAX), a funded account (Topstep style), a stock portfolio (AAPL, SAP, options) and a crypto wallet (BTC, ETH). The ~1,000 trades are spread chronologically across 2024 to mid-2026 with a win rate around 57 % – so equity curves, time heatmaps and monthly views are meaningful from the start.

17.3 The core idea: minimal vs. maximal

The key takeaway: how much analysis you get depends on how much you maintain. Two deliberate extremes show this.

The minimal entry

The "Test strategy" consists of trades with the absolute minimum: only account, asset, strategy and a win or loss. No stop, no planning, no checklist.

Even with minimal data:

- Win rate, net P&L, profit factor, expectancy in €
- Winning/losing streaks, equity curve, drawdown
- Breakdown by account, asset, strategy, weekday/hour

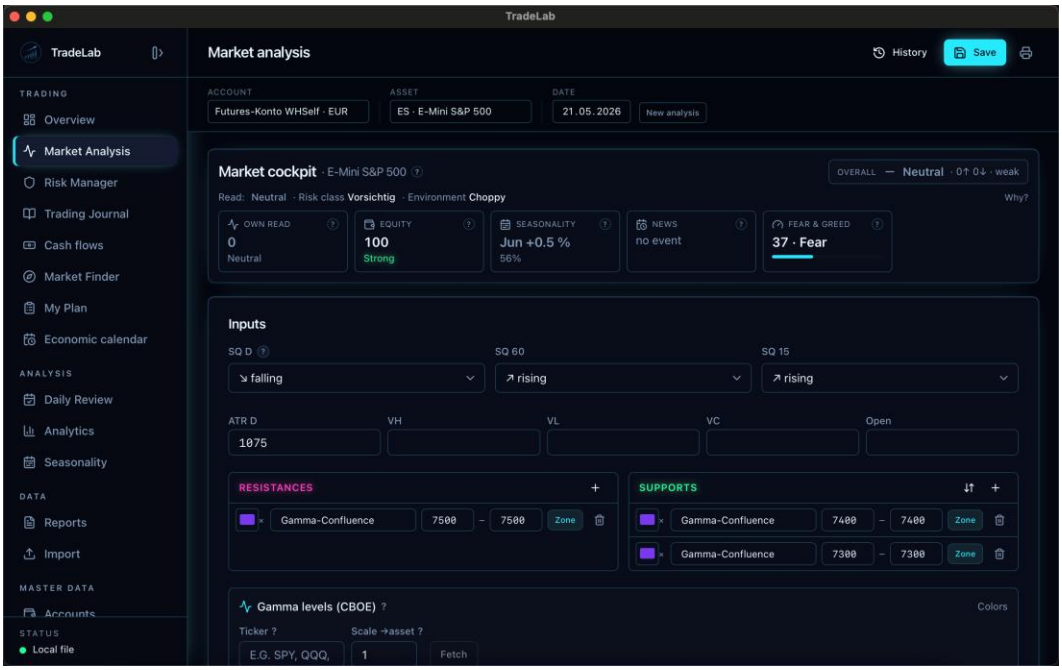
Minimal data CANNOT:

- No R-multiple (no defined risk without a stop)
- No discipline analysis (no checklist)
- No execution quality/slippage (no planned price)
- No MAE/MFE, mental or context analysis

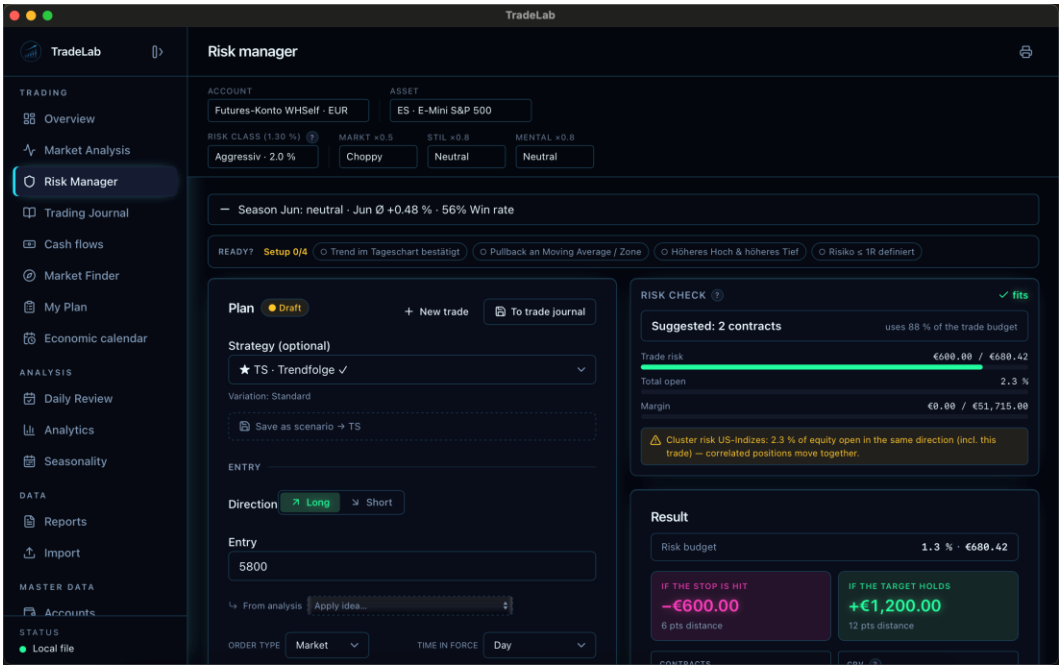
The maximal entry

Each account has one fully maintained trade: with planned vs. actual entry (slippage), stop and target, plan phases, a fully ticked checklist, mental state, MAE/MFE, order types and notes. Only this unlocks R-multiple, discipline-vs-outcome, execution quality and confidence calibration. In short: the more you maintain, the more leverage the app reveals.

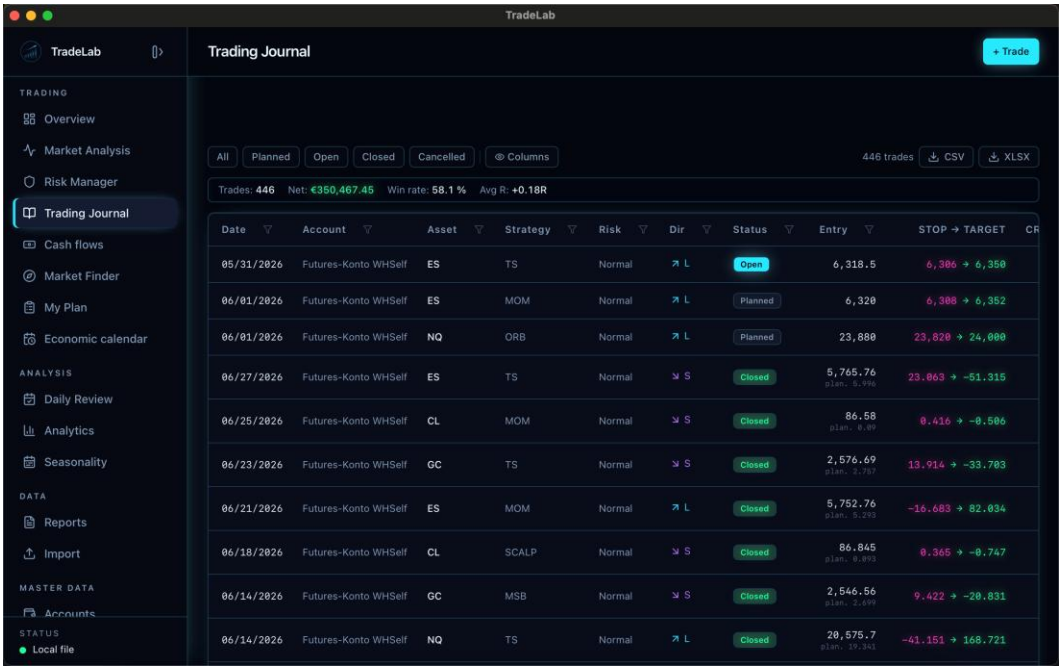
17.4 Page by page – how to read it



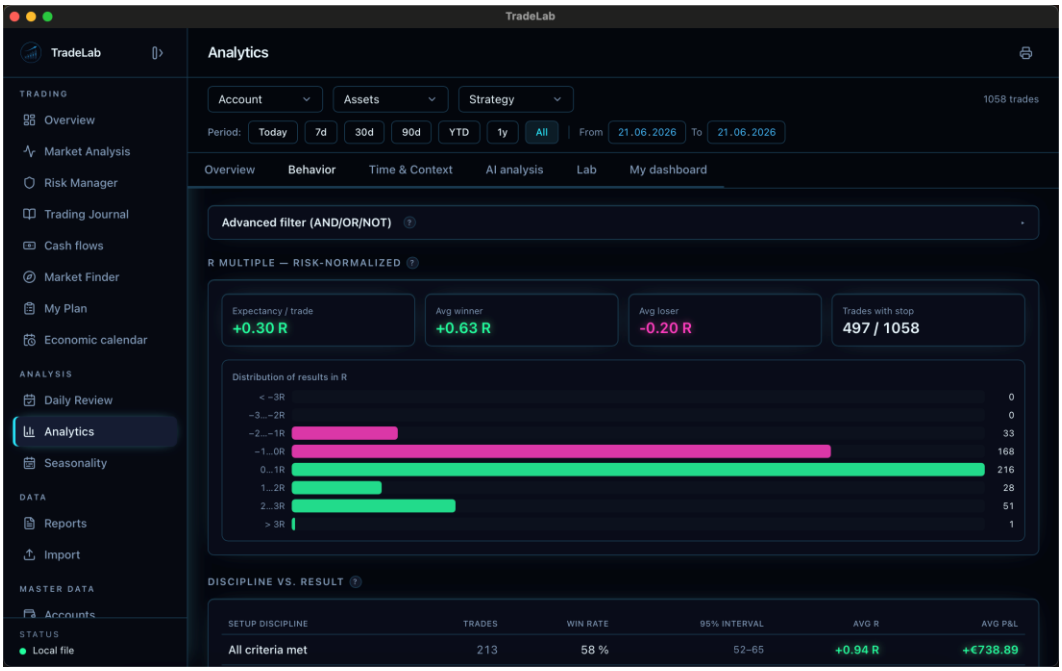
Market cockpit: own view, season, news and Fear&Greed converge into one overall read.



Risk manager: position size from risk-% and stop, with margin and heat checks.



Journal: the filtered demo history across all accounts.



Behavior tab: R-multiple distribution + discipline table with 95% Wilson interval. The fusion analyses (seasonal alignment, ATR regime, confidence calibration) live here too.

Important when reading: a difference marked “exploratory” is NOT robust – wide confidence intervals mean uncertainty. Exactly this honesty separates serious analysis from number cosmetics.

17.5 The test strategies

So that strategy analyses are populated, the demo trades use six named strategies:

- **TS** – trend following: in the direction of the higher-timeframe trend.

- **MOM** – momentum breakout: breakout above a key level with momentum.
- **ORB** – opening range breakout: breakout from the opening range.
- **MSB** – market structure break: a break of market structure.
- **FADE** – counter-trend: fading a move at extremes.
- **SCALP** – scalping: short intraday trades.

17.6 Demo limits & full version

- **10 trades/month:** the remaining quota is shown in the sidebar; demo data doesn't count.
- **AI optional:** runs locally via Ollama (free). Without it a placeholder appears.
- **Data ownership:** everything local (SQLite), optionally synced to NAS/iCloud.
- The **full version** removes the trade limit – everything else is identical.

Tip: create your own account and instrument (template catalog) and plan a trade in the risk manager – that's how you experience the full workflow with your own data.

18. Glossary

- **R / R-multiple** – result ÷ initial risk.
- **Expectancy** – average result per trade over the long run.
- **Profit factor** – sum of wins ÷ sum of losses.
- **MAE / MFE** – furthest move against / for you during the trade (in ticks).
- **Advantage / SQ** – weighted strength consensus across timeframes (−100…+100).
- **Heat** – simultaneously open risk as a percentage of equity.
- **OCO / TIF** – linked stop-and-target order / order validity (day/gtc/gtd).
- **Confluence** – several independent signals point the same way.
- **Wilson interval** – honest range of a win rate on a small sample.